

Notification of New JETRO Regional and Analysis Reports (September 3, 2026 Issue)

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Thank you for using JETRO Members Service.

We are pleased to provide you with information on newly published regional and analysis reports that JETRO prepares from its unique perspective on political and economic trends in major countries and regions worldwide. We hope you will find these reports useful.

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[Special Feature] Opportunities in the European Market: Initiatives of Mid-sized and Small Enterprises <Additional Article>

For Japanese companies, particularly mid-sized and small enterprises with limited human and financial resources, the European market often presents high barriers due to geographic distance and regulatory challenges. However, Europe has many consumers who recognize the value of high value-added products in which Japanese companies excel, and brand strength built in Europe can be leveraged when developing other markets. Through case studies of primarily small and medium-sized enterprises conducting business in Europe, this report introduces the appeal Japanese companies find in the European market despite existing hurdles, as well as methods to overcome challenges.

<Additional Article>

◇Three Principles for Overseas Expansion of Alcoholic Beverages from Scratch

[Special Feature] Exploring New Forward-Looking Japan-Korea Industrial Collaboration Possibilities <Additional Article>

To commemorate the 60th anniversary of Japan-Korea diplomatic relations in 2025, JETRO established the "Forward-Looking Japan-Korea Business Research Council" to explore and discuss new areas of cooperation less susceptible to political fluctuations. The council has invited experts active in both Japan and Korea as members and has conducted repeated discussions on new forms of Japan-Korea cooperation. This special feature first reviews Japan-Korea economic relations, and then presents council members' perspectives in interview format on future directions and collaboration possibilities based on council discussions. Additionally, interviews with guest speakers knowledgeable in collaboration-potential fields—content (music, games), e-commerce, and startups—that were discussed in the research council are included, exploring concrete collaboration opportunities.

<Additional Article>

◇Kakao Investment on the Possibilities of Japan-Korea Collaboration in the Content Sector

[Special Feature] Business Cases in Africa <Additional Article>

In Africa, diverse business opportunities are emerging not only for large enterprises with networks and capital, but also for startups with cutting-edge technology and small and medium-sized enterprises in various fields. Additionally, diverse approaches are possible for each country, including collaboration with third-country enterprises and local companies with proven track records. In this special feature, covering movements around the 9th Tokyo International Conference on African Development (TICAD9) in fiscal years 2024-2025, African business has been introduced concretely. In fiscal year 2026, with an eye toward the next TICAD10, the feature will cover a wide range of business cases of Japanese and local enterprises, centered on company interviews, exploring new business opportunities and collaboration possibilities emerging locally, and providing hints for business expansion.

<Additional Articles>

■Japanese Enterprise Cases – Manufacturing Sector's African Expansion

◇Hearing from Japanese Companies: Business Opportunities and Challenges Arising from South Africa's Railway Reform

■Japanese Enterprise Cases – African Expansion from Across Japan

◇Solving Transportation and Energy Issues Through Electric Two-Wheeler Business: Musashi Seimitsu Industry

[Special Feature] Turbulent Middle East Situation: Impact on and Outlook for Middle Eastern Countries <Additional Article>

Due to instability in the Middle East situation, the business environment surrounding companies operating in the region is undergoing major changes. This special feature tracks the Middle East and North Africa (MENA) region regarding recent trends in logistics and trade and various industries, corporate initiatives, and investigates and analyzes government responses and economic policies according to circumstances. Through these efforts, the report broadly introduces information serving Japanese companies' future Middle East business, clarifying geopolitical risks and new market opportunities in the MENA region from multiple perspectives.

<Additional Articles>

◇Turbulent Iraq (1): Zaydi New Administration Takes on Corruption and Armed Group Control

◇MENA Major Port Trends (2): How the Middle East Crisis is Reshaping Mediterranean Port Dynamics

[United States] National Governors Association Summer Meeting

The National Governors Association is a bipartisan organization composed of governors from the 50 U.S. states and five territories and protectorates. National meetings are held twice yearly, in winter and summer, serving as a venue where state governors share experiences and policies regarding challenges facing state governments. The 2026 Summer Meeting was held July 30 – August 1 in Oklahoma City, Oklahoma.

With the U.S. midterm elections in November 2026 approaching, and with an eye toward the 2028 presidential election, political activity is gradually intensifying. At this meeting held amid such circumstances, topics included changes to employment structures caused by artificial intelligence (AI),